

Information Technology Policy

Credential security, data backups & BYOD

Purpose & Scope

This policy defines the minimum technical and behavioral standards required to protect Acme Corp's systems, credentials, and data. It applies to all employees using company accounts, corporate storage, or personal devices for work purposes, and forms the baseline for IT security expectations across the organization.

Definitions

Credential	Any username, password, token, or key used to authenticate to a company system or account.
OneDrive Repository	Acme Corp's officially sanctioned cloud storage location for corporate work documents and data.
BYOD	Bring Your Own Device — a personal smartphone or laptop used to access corporate email or internal networks.
MDM	Mobile Device Management software that enforces encryption and enables remote wipe on registered devices.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Maintain compliant passwords, save work to OneDrive, and register any personal device before use.
IT Department	Enforce password policy technically, monitor backup jobs, and manage the BYOD device registration process.
Line Manager	Ensure new team members complete IT onboarding, including password setup and OneDrive synchronization.
Security Team	Investigate suspected credential compromise and coordinate remote wipe for lost or stolen devices.

1. Password & Credential Security

Employees must secure all company accounts using passwords that are a minimum of 12 characters in length, containing at least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character.

Passwords must be changed every 90 days to limit exposure from potentially compromised credentials. The system will prompt employees ahead of the expiry date to allow time for an orderly password change.

Strong, unique passwords reduce the risk of unauthorized access resulting from credential-stuffing attacks, where credentials leaked from unrelated services are reused against corporate systems.

- Do not reuse a personal account password for any Acme Corp system.
- Avoid predictable patterns such as sequential numbers or common substitutions (e.g., replacing 'a' with '@').

■ Prohibited

Sharing passwords or credentials via email, messaging apps, or written notes is strictly prohibited under all circumstances, including with colleagues covering for an absent employee.

2. Automatic Data Backups

All corporate work documents and data must be saved to official company OneDrive repositories. An automated daily sync runs every night at 11:00 PM to back up all cloud storage folders to secure corporate servers.

Because the backup process only covers officially sanctioned storage locations, work saved outside of OneDrive falls outside the protection of this automated process entirely.

- Save active project files directly to a OneDrive-synced folder rather than a local 'Desktop' or 'Documents' folder.
- Confirm sync status periodically via the OneDrive icon in the system tray or menu bar.

■ Important

Personal hard drives or local desktop folders are NOT backed up by this process. Any data lost from local drives is not recoverable — always work from OneDrive.

3. Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) Registry

Employees wishing to access corporate email or internal networks from personal smartphones or laptops must register their device with the IT department before connecting.

Registration allows IT to maintain visibility over which personal devices hold corporate data, which is a prerequisite for enforcing encryption and enabling remote-wipe protection if a device is later lost or stolen.

- Registered devices must have mobile device management (MDM) software installed.
- MDM ensures data encryption on the device and enables remote wipe functionality if the device is lost or stolen.
- Unregistered personal devices should not be used to access corporate email, files, or internal networks under any circumstances.

Standard Procedure — Registering a Personal Device (BYOD)

- 1 Contact the IT service desk to request BYOD registration.
- 2 Provide the device type, operating system, and intended use (email, files, or both).
- 3 Install the MDM client provided by IT and complete the enrollment steps.
- 4 Confirm encryption is active and the device appears in the IT device registry.
- 5 Report any loss, theft, or replacement of the device to IT immediately so it can be wiped or de-registered.

Frequently Asked Questions

What if I forget my password before the 90-day change?

Use the self-service password reset in the HR Portal login page, or contact the IT service desk for assistance.

Can I store files temporarily on my desktop before moving them to OneDrive?

This is discouraged. Files should be created or saved directly into a OneDrive-synced folder to avoid any gap in backup coverage.

Does BYOD registration give IT access to my personal photos or apps?

MDM enforcement is scoped to corporate data and security controls such as encryption and remote wipe; contact IT directly for details on what the specific MDM client covers.

What happens if I lose a registered device?

Report it to IT immediately so they can initiate a remote wipe of corporate data through the MDM system.

Non-Compliance & Enforcement

Non-compliant passwords will be rejected by the system at creation or change time. Sharing credentials or accessing corporate resources from an unregistered device may result in account suspension pending investigation and will be addressed under Acme Corp's information security and disciplinary procedures.

Example Scenarios

Scenario: Setting up a new laptop

A new employee receives a company laptop and is prompted to create a password during first login. They choose a 14-character passphrase with mixed case, a number, and a special character, and save all onboarding documents directly into their OneDrive folder.

Scenario: Working from a personal phone

An employee wants to check work email from their personal phone while traveling. Before doing so, they contact IT to register the device and install the required MDM client, ensuring the phone is encrypted and can be remotely wiped if lost.

Scenario: A laptop left on a train

An employee reports a lost company laptop to IT within the hour. Because the device was registered and MDM-enrolled, IT is able to trigger a remote wipe, protecting any corporate data stored on the device.

Related Policies & Resources

- Information Security Policy — broader data classification and handling standards
- Acceptable Use Policy — permitted use of corporate systems and internet access
- Incident Response Guidelines — reporting suspected security incidents

Quick Reference — IT Policy

Item	Policy
Minimum password length	12 characters
Password complexity	Upper + lower case, number, special character
Password rotation	Every 90 days
Credential sharing	Strictly prohibited (email, messaging, written notes)
Approved storage	Company OneDrive only
Backup schedule	Automated daily sync at 11:00 PM
Local drive backups	Not performed — not recoverable if lost
BYOD requirement	Register with IT department before use
BYOD software	MDM mandatory (encryption + remote wipe)

Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Changes
1.0	July 13, 2026	Initial consolidated publication of the IT policy for the Enterprise Policy Assistant.

This document is the authoritative source for this policy area. In the event of any discrepancy with summaries, training materials, or third-party references, this policy document takes precedence. Questions not addressed here should be directed to the relevant owning department listed under Roles & Responsibilities.